DAVID BLAZAR

Malen Professor for Urban Education Policy | University of Maryland, College Park

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Research: teacher workforce and teacher education • teacher effectiveness and instructional improvement • education policy and inequality

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS & AFFILIATIONS

Malen Professor for Urban Education Policy, University of Maryland, College Park	2026–present
Associate Professor, Teaching and Learning, Policy and Leadership, University of Maryland	2022–present
Assistant Professor, Teaching and Learning, Policy and Leadership, University of Maryland	2017–2022
Faculty Director, Maryland Equity Project, University of Maryland	2019–present
Research Branch Principal Investigator, Maryland Longitudinal Data System	2017–present
Faculty Affiliate, Department of Economics; Faculty Associate, Maryland Population Research Center, UMD	2026–present
Faculty Affiliate, School of Public Policy, University of Maryland	2018–present
Visiting Researcher, Department of Economics, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid	2025–2026

Prior Appointments

Postdoctoral Fellow and Lecturer, Harvard Graduate School of Education	2016–2017
English Language Arts Teacher, George Washington High School, New York City Department of Education	2006–2009

EDUCATION

EdD, Quantitative Policy Analysis in Education, Harvard Graduate School of Education	2016
EdM, Education Policy and Management, Harvard Graduate School of Education	2011
MST, Curriculum and Instruction, Fordham Graduate School of Education	2008
AB, History and Literature, cum laude, Harvard College	2006

SELECTED HONORS

Edu-Scholar Public Influence Rankings, Top 200, Education Week	2025
Reviewer of the Year, Journal of Research on Educational Effectiveness	2025
Outstanding Reviewer, Educational Researcher	2017, 2021, 2024, 2025
Excellence in Scholarship, Pre-Tenure Faculty, College of Education, University of Maryland	2021
Jean Flanigan Dissertation Award, Association for Education Finance and Policy	2017
Emerging Education Policy Scholar, Thomas B. Fordham Institute	2015

PUBLICATIONS

** Graduate student or postdoctoral fellow at the time of collaboration.*

Refereed Journal Articles

Blazar, D., Boudreaux, M., Klees, S., Rice, J.K., Titus, M., & Zhao, J.* (2026). Disparities in childhood human capital investments in the United States. *Nature Communications*, 17, 1–19.

Blazar, D., Anthenelli, M.*, Gao, W.*, Goings, R., & Gershenson, S. (Online 2026). Disparate pathways: Understanding racial disparities in teaching. *Educational Evaluation and Policy Analysis*.

Lagos, F.*, & **Blazar, D.** (Online 2026). Professional staff diversity and student outcomes: Extending our understanding of race/ethnicity-matching effects in education. *Educational Researcher*.

Blazar, D., Gao, W.*, Lagos, F.*, Goings, R., & Gershenson, S. (2026). Localized teacher recruitment through "grow-your-own": Impacts of the high school Teacher Academy of Maryland program. *Journal of Policy Analysis and Management*, 42(2), e70084.

Blazar, D., Adnot, M., Anthenelli, M.*, & Zhong, X.* (2025). Differential responses to teacher evaluation incentives: Expectancy, race, experience, and task. *Educational Evaluation and Policy Analysis*, 47(4), 1314–1340.

Blazar, D., Song, D.*, Goings, R., Plasman, J., & Gottfried, M. (2025). Pathways into the CTE teaching profession: A descriptive analysis of degrees, licenses, and race in Maryland. *AERA Open*, 11(1), 1–20.

Blazar, D. (2024). Why Black teachers matter. *Educational Researcher*, 53(8), 450–463.

Blazar, D., McNamara, D.*, & Blue, G. (2024). Instructional coaching personnel and program scalability. *Education Finance and Policy*, 19(3), 492–523.

Blazar, D., & Schueler, B. (2024). Effective school district policies and practices: Synthesizing theoretical frameworks and empirical findings across disciplines. *Journal of Research on Educational Effectiveness*, 17(4), 647–686.

Blazar, D., & Pollard, C.* (2023). Challenges and tradeoffs of "good" teaching: The pursuit of multiple educational outcomes. *Journal of Teacher Education*, 74(3), 229–244.

Gottfried, M., Plasman, J., & **Blazar, D.** (2022). Exclusive versus mixed, general versus CTE: Building a new taxonomy of STEMM high school teachers. *Journal of Education Human Resources*.

Blazar, D., & Archer, C.* (2020). Teaching to support students with diverse academic needs. *Educational Researcher*, 49(5), 297–311.

Blazar, D., Heller, B.*, Kane, T. J., Polikoff, M., & Staiger, D. O., with Carrell, S., Goldhaber, D., Harris, D., Hitch, R., Holden, K. L., & Kurlaender, M. (2020). Curriculum reform in the Common Core era: Evaluating elementary math textbooks across six U.S. states. *Journal of Policy Analysis and Management*, 39(4), 966–1019.

Blazar, D. (2020). Teacher coaching to improve instruction at scale: Opportunities and challenges in a policy context. *Teachers College Record*, 122(10).

Kane, T. J., **Blazar, D.**, Gehlbach, H., Greenberg, M., Quinn, D., & Thal, D. (2020). Substituting teacher-collected video for formal classroom observations: An experimental evaluation. *Education Finance and Policy*, 15(3), 397–427.

Blazar, D., & Kraft, M. A. (2019). Balancing rigor, replication, and relevance: A case for multiple-cohort, longitudinal experiments. *AERA Open*, 5(3), 1–18.

Blazar, D. (2018). Validating teacher effects on students' attitudes and behaviors: Evidence from random assignment of teachers to students. *Education Finance and Policy*, 13(3), 281–309.

Blazar, D., Gilbert, B., Herlihy, C., & Gogolen, C. (2018). Exploring the potential for video-based classroom observations. *International Journal of Education in Mathematics, Science and Technology*, 6(2), 122–135.

Kraft, M. A., **Blazar, D.**, & Hogan, D.* (2018). The effect of teacher coaching on instruction and achievement: A meta-analysis of the causal evidence. *Review of Educational Research*, 88(4), 547–588.

Blazar, D., Braslow, D., Charalambous, C. Y., & Hill, H. C. (2017). Attending to general and mathematics-specific dimensions of teaching: Exploring factors across two observation instruments. *Educational Assessment*, 22(2), 71–94.

Blazar, D., & Kraft, M. A. (2017). Teacher and teaching effects on students' attitudes and behaviors. *Educational Evaluation and Policy Analysis*, 39(1), 146–170.

Blazar, D., & Pollard, C.* (2017). Does test preparation mean low-quality instruction? *Educational Researcher*, 46(8), 420–433.

Kraft, M. A., & **Blazar, D.** (2017). Individualized coaching to improve teacher practice across grades and subjects: New experimental evidence. *Educational Policy*, 31(7), 1033–1068.

Lynch, K., Chin, M., & **Blazar, D.** (2017). Relationship between observations of elementary teacher mathematics instruction and student achievement: Exploring variability across districts. *American Journal of Education*, 123(4), 615–646.

Blazar, D., Litke, E., & Barmore, J. (2016). What does it mean to be ranked a "high" or "low" value-added teacher? Observing differences in instructional quality across districts. *American Educational Research Journal*, 53(2), 324–359.

Blazar, D. (2015). Effective teaching in elementary mathematics: Identifying classroom practices that support student achievement. *Economics of Education Review*, 48, 16–29.

Blazar, D. (2015). Grade assignments and the teacher pipeline: A low-cost lever to improve student achievement? *Educational Researcher*, 44(4), 213–227.

Blazar, D., & Kraft, M. A. (2015). Exploring mechanisms of effective teacher coaching: A tale of two cohorts from a randomized experiment. *Educational Evaluation and Policy Analysis*, 37(4), 542–566.

Hill, H. C., **Blazar, D.**, & Lynch, K. (2015). Resources for teaching: Examining personal and institutional predictors of high-quality instruction. *AERA Open*, 1(4), 1–23.

Hill, H. C., Charalambous, C. Y., **Blazar, D.**, McGinn, D., Beisiegel, M., Humez, A., Kraft, M., Litke, E., & Lynch, K. (2012). Validating arguments for observational instruments: Attending to multiple sources of variation. *Educational Assessment*, 17(2–3), 88–106.

Blazar, D. (2011). Using theatre to engage cultural identity: Implications for students and teachers. *English Education*, 43(3), 294–304.

Blazar, D. (2009). Self-discovery through character connections: Opening up to gayness in Angels in America. *English Journal*, 98(4), 77–84.

Selected publication distinctions: *Kraft, Blazar, & Hogan (2018) was the most-read article in Review of Educational Research in 2018; Blazar & Kraft (2017) was the most-read article in EEPA in 2017; the 2018 coaching meta-analysis and 2026 grow-your-own study were cited in the Economic Report of the President.*

Selected Working Papers

Blazar, D. Teaching Tradeoffs: Short-Term Gains, Long-run Consequences.

Blazar, D., Song, D.*, Waller, A.*, Carson, N.*, Zhao, J.*, & Galindo, C. Expanding educational opportunity for Black, Latinx, and low-income students: Evidence from 307 randomized trials on achievement, SEL, and attainment.

Blazar, D., & Yaow, Y.H.* Service Scholarships Grow the Teacher Workforce, but Design Determines Who Benefits.

Dominguez, N.*, Morris, W.*, Montana, S.*, & **Blazar, D.** Teacher preparation, localness, and student achievement.

Montana, S.*, Dominguez, N.*, Morris, W.*, & **Blazar, D.** The emerging case for investing in the paraprofessional-to-teacher pipeline: Evidence from Maryland.

Morris, W.*, & **Blazar, D.** Layered reforms and the structure of teacher pay: Descriptive evidence from Maryland.

Troyer, M., **Blazar, D.**, Donovan, S., & Ahmed, W. The science of reading and the teaching of reading: Exploring instructional practice and student achievement in early literacy classrooms.

SELECTED SPONSORED RESEARCH

Co-Principal Investigator. "Preparing High School Students for the Challenges of Democracy," Leonard Schaeffer Foundation ($2.5M total; $200,000 UMD subcontract). 2025–2030

Principal Investigator. "Using Rigorous Evidence to Build a Strategic Vision for the Teacher Pipeline in Baltimore City and Maryland," Abell Foundation and Richman Foundation ($30,000). 2025–2026

Investigator and UMD Principal Investigator. "CALDER Recruitment and Retention Center," Institute of Education Sciences ($10M total; $749,032 UMD subcontract). 2024–2029

Co-Principal Investigator. "Computer Science for All?," Google Foundation ($300,000). 2024–2027

Principal Investigator. "Transforming Education Systems: Promoting Teacher Diversity through Culturally Responsive Pathways, Pedagogies, and Policymaking," Spencer Foundation ($70,000). 2024–2025

Co-Principal Investigator. "Using Maryland's SLDS to Strengthen and Diversify the Teacher Workforce through High School-to-Career Pathways," Institute of Education Sciences ($1M total; $185,190 UMD subcontract). 2024–2026

External Evaluator. "Scaling a National Model of Reading Engagement (MORE)," U.S. Department of Education, Education Innovation and Research ($150,000 subcontract). 2024–2028

Co-Principal Investigator. "Research to Inform Maryland Blueprint Accountability and Implementation Board Decision-Making," Maryland AIB ($69,864). 2023–2025

Co-Principal Investigator. "Sustaining Literacy Practices over Time: Codifying Knowledge through Micro-Credentialing," Institute of Education Sciences ($2M total; $483,936 subcontract). 2022–2026

Principal Investigator. "Examining Recruitment Programs and Pathways to Diversify the Teacher Workforce," Institute of Education Sciences ($577,149). 2021–2024

Principal Investigator. "Disparities in Investments in Children and Youth in the United States," Spencer Foundation ($999,024). 2019–2024

Co-Principal Investigator. "Maryland Longitudinal Data Systems Center: Research Branch," State of Maryland ($584,754). 2018–2023

SELECTED INVITED TALKS & KEYNOTES

Princeton University; University College London; University of Oslo; University of Zurich 2026

French Center for Educational Systems Studies (Cnesco); Johns Hopkins University; Maryland Professional Standards and Teacher Education Board; Rey Juan Carlos University; University of Valencia 2025

Educators Rising Maryland Annual Conference; Educational Testing Service; Code.org Computer Science National Advocacy Coalition; Maryland P20 Collaborative Workgroup 2024

University of Zurich; Urban Institute 2022

SELECTED POLICY & PUBLIC SCHOLARSHIP

Blazar, D., & Boudreaux, M. (2026). Congress debates childhood by budget lines. Children don't live that way. *The Hill*.

Blazar, D. (2026). Black teachers improve outcomes for all students, but the profession remains largely white. *The Conversation*.

Blazar, D. (2025). Learning from teacher evaluations that work. *Brookings Brown Center Chalkboard*.

Blazar, D., Gao, W.*, Gershenson, S., Goings, R., & Lagos, F.* (2024). "Grow-your-own" programs can help expand and diversify the teacher workforce. *Maryland Longitudinal Data System Center*.

Blazar, D., Gao, W.*, Gershenson, S., Goings, R., & Lagos, F.* (2024). Empowering local talent: Evaluating the impact of grow-your-own teacher programs. *IZA World of Labor*.

Blazar, D., Gershenson, S., & Goings, R. (2024). The educational and labor market outcomes of Maryland's grow-your-own teacher recruitment program. *Urban Institute*.

Kraft, M. A., & **Blazar, D.** (2018). Taking teacher coaching to scale: Can personalized training become standard practice? *Education Next*.

TEACHING & PROGRAM LEADERSHIP

Courses Taught

Economics of Education (TLPL 670) 2017–present

Impact Evaluation for Education and Public Policy (TLPL 766) 2018–2024

Education Policy Research, Writing, and Presentation Seminar (TLPL 788Z) 2019–present

Data Management for Social Science Research (TLPL 788D) 2018–present

Program Development & Leadership

Co-developed undergraduate Educational Studies degree and cross-college Education Policy concentration, UMD College of Education and School of Public Policy 2021–present

Co-developed master's concentration in Education Policy with cross-listed coursework across Education and Public Policy 2020–present

Revised Teacher Education and Professional Development specialization benchmarks and course requirements 2020–2021

Co-developed four-course Quantitative Research Methods sequence 2018–present

ADVISING & MENTORING

Postdoctoral Fellows

Wesley Morris — placement: University of Memphis 2025–2026

Kayla Bill — placement: Florida State University 2023–2025

Francisco Lagos — placement: Inter-American Development Bank; also offered academic position 2022–2024

Doctoral Advisor / Dissertation Chair or Co-Chair

Current advisees: Sarah Montana, Xiaoxue Zhou (co-advisor), Deborah Euzebio, Tracee Matthias, Nandi Carson, Kathleen Perry, Danett Song, Jiehui Zhao, Renata Lyons, and Erin Janulis.

Graduates: Francisco Lagos (2022; Inter-American Development Bank) and Casey Archer (2021; AnLar).

Additional Mentoring

Junior faculty mentoring: Meghan Comstock and Jing Liu. Additional committee service includes 16 doctoral dissertation committees across Education Policy, Economics, Public Policy, Communication, Public Health, and related fields, and 9 master's advisees.

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL & UNIVERSITY LEADERSHIP

Editorial Leadership

Editorial Board, Journal of Research on Educational Effectiveness 2025–present

Editorial Board, Educational Researcher 2021–present

Editorial Board, Educational Evaluation and Policy Analysis 2020–2024

Editorial Board, AERA Open 2019–2024

External Advisory & Professional Roles

Collaborating Researcher, Research Partnership for Professional Learning 2022–present

Advisor, Strategic Data Project Fellowship, Center for Education Policy Research, Harvard University 2017–present

Member, Diversifying the Teacher Workforce Expert Panel, RAND Corporation 2022

Member, Technical Working Group on Teacher Residencies, Institute of Education Sciences 2020

Member, Technical Working Group on Teacher and School Leader Incentive Program, Institute of Education Sciences 2019

Selected University Leadership

Division Coordinator, Education Policy, Urban Education, and Teacher Education and Professional Development, UMD 2022–23; 2024–25

Co-Chair, Appointment, Promotion, and Tenure Subcommittee, UMD 2024–2025

Member, Academic Program Review, UMD 2024–2025